

EXPLORE.....

**The newsletter of the
Friends of Telford Town Park**

Spring 2014

Promoting . Conserving . Protecting
www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

Spring 2014



Welcome to the Spring 2014 edition of the Friends of Telford Town Park (FOT-TP) newsletter 'Explore'. We are the Park's main volunteer group and have over 20 members who give their time to promote, conserve and protect Telford Town Park by getting involved in many different activities from general maintenance and gardening to supporting and organising events.

Our Explore newsletter gives details of the work we have been doing recently and what is coming up in the next few months. We hope it will inspire you to come along to this beautiful park and explore the many places and activities on offer and perhaps even get involved in some of the work that we do.

If you would like more information about the Friends, find out how to become a member and the volunteering opportunities on offer or if you would like to contact us visit our website: www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

If you are interested in volunteering on an occasional basis and for specific types of activities but do not want to become a member of the group, please contact the Telford Town Park Visitor Centre on 01952 - 382340 or email telfordtownpark@telford.gov.uk for further information.

We are grateful to Great Dawley Town Council for sponsoring the Friends 'Explore' newsletters. The Friends of Telford Town Park are also supported by Telford & Wrekin Council, The Heritage Lottery Fund, Madeley Town Council, The parish councils of Stirchley & Brookside , Hollinswood & Randlay, Lawley & Overdale and the Southwater Event Group.

SANTA FUN RUN RAISES £2000

The 7th Santa Fun Run organised by the Friends took place on Sunday 8 December in the Town Park raising more than £2,000 for the Royal National Institute of Blind People (RNIB) and Guide Dogs UK. This achievement now makes the total raised from all seven events just over £14,000.

The 2013 event was the biggest ever, attracting almost 200 runners, joggers and walkers on the day, all festively dressed as Father Christmas. There were even some dogs dressed up for the occasion! For the first time, the Friends linked up with the volunteers from Park Run Telford, who marshalled a 5km route adding to the existing 2km route. Also, registration and payment of sponsorship money online was made available for the first time.



Cheques were presented for £1,000 each to RNIB and Guide Dogs UK, on Wednesday 19 March. Pictured left to right: Janice Williams, Friends Public Relations Manager, Rowland Brown and Daniel from Guide Dogs UK, Rachel Evans, local RNIB volunteer.

We would like to take this opportunity to thank our event sponsors - Asda Telford and Waitrose Newport who provided the mince pies and Closer to the Edge (rope course operator in the Town Park) who provided the raffle top prize of Experience Vouchers for 8 people and of course all of the people who joined in and made this such a wonderful event.

The 2014 Santa Fun Run will be taking place on Sunday 7 December. Registration will be available from August onwards. For details visit:
www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

Park Run is a 5km timed run in Telford Town Park which starts at 9am on Saturday mornings. For further details visit: www.parkrun.org.uk/telford

FRIENDS WIN NATIONAL AWARD

The Friends of Telford Town Park were delighted to receive the 'Best Have a Field Day with Join In 2013' award for their Jolly Green Day community event which took place on Saturday 17 August on the Queen Elizabeth II Field (formerly known as the Arena) in the Town Park.

The award was made by Fields in Trust (formerly The Playing Fields Association) at a dinner held at Lords Cricket Ground in London last November. The nine acre Arena is now protected from future development by Fields in Trust.

The Jolly Green Day event was a free fun day which celebrated the great outdoors and the protection of the environment and was organised by the Friends to celebrate their 10th anniversary and the first year of the Telford Green Spaces Partnership (TGSP), a forum of 19 voluntary groups who all support and protect various public green spaces in and around the borough of Telford and Wrekin.



L to R: Former professional footballer and FIT Ambassador Graeme Le Saux, Chair of the Friends of Telford Town Park Chris Pettman, Jolly Green Day Event Organiser Janice Williams and former athlete and Director for Sport 'Join In' Dave Moorcroft

NEW PUBLIC RELATIONS MANAGER

The Friends are delighted to announce the appointment of a new Public Relations Manager, Janice Williams. Janice brings a wealth of experience in marketing and event management to the group and played a major part in the planning and delivery of the Jolly Green Day event last August.

We wish her every success in the post which forms part of the Executive Committee. The Friends are always busy in the Park so we are sure Janice will be too!

To contact Janice - email: [REDACTED] or on her mobile: [REDACTED].

NEW SPONSORSHIP DEAL



We are delighted to announce that as from 1 April 2014, the Southwater Event Group (SEG) will be sponsoring the Friends of Telford Town Park. Last summer they gave us some invaluable help with our Jolly Green Day event by printing posters and leaflets and free parking on the day. An agreement is now in place for their support to continue this year and we look forward to working with them.

The Southwater Event Group comprises the Telford International Centre, The Holiday Inn, The International Hotel and the Ramada Hotel. For further information about the group visit:
www.southwatereventgroup.com

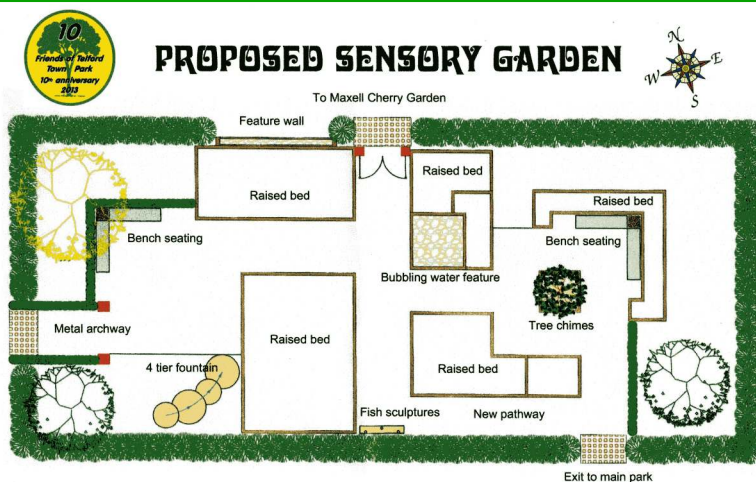
SOUTHWATER ONE VISIT



During March a group of the Friends had a guided tour around the new 'Southwater One' Council building which is currently nearing completion. As the Friends were part of the consultation process during the planning phases of the project, with particular regard to the interface between the development and the Park, they were very keen to see how things were progressing. The top picture shows a view of the new lake spreading across on the right towards the new boule pitch and the Town Park. Below are some of the group about to go up to the top floor. We are grateful to Jo Middleton of Telford & Wrekin Council and the site manager for giving us this insight into progress. To find out more about the Southwater development visit: www.heartoftelford.co.uk



SENSORY GARDEN GETS UNDERWAY



Work is now underway on the ground works for the new sensory garden in the Park's Chelsea Gardens. It is expected that the work will take 3 - 4 weeks. As soon as this stage has been completed, the Friends 'Drop in Gardening Group' will begin planting and preparing the garden for an official opening later in the year.

The overall size of the sensory garden is 24m x 12m and has been designed by the Friends' 'Drop in Gardening Group' together with professional landscape architect Teresa Rham, to create a design to replace the old rose garden. Funding of £15,000 for this project has been received from the Town Park and the Parks for People Lottery fund. Donations of cash and equipment have also been received from local companies.

Volunteering Opportunities

There's always plenty of work to be done in the Park and we are always delighted to welcome new volunteers. Whether you want to spend just a few hours now and again or would like to be a regular volunteer, whatever time you can spare would be appreciated and you may well enjoy it too!

Drop in Gardening Group (Chelsea Gardens/New Sensory Garden)

Every first and third Wednesday of the month- 10am to 1pm. General garden maintenance and an opportunity to learn about plants and gain new skills. All tools provided. Meet at the Visitor Centre.

FOTTP Maintenance Work Days

2nd Saturday and 4th Thursday of each month. 10am to 1pm.

Carrying out seasonal maintenance in various locations around the Park. All tools and supervision provided. Meet at the Visitor Centre.

WHAT'S ON IN THE PARK

There's always lots going on in the Park for people of all ages. With the Easter holidays coming up there's plenty for children and families and most of it is free of charge.

- Playground including trim trail for all ages
 - Water play area
 - Fishing in several lakes. Day tickets available*
 - NEW heritage and nature trails - maps available
 - NEW adventure 12 hole golf course*
 - NEW Aerial rope course and zip wire*
 - NEW regular guided walk programme starting from April
 - NEW Walking for Health walks every second Sunday of the month at 2pm
- * denotes fees payable - payment for activities and maps available from the Visitor Centre*

EASTER HOLIDAY ACTIVITIES FOR CHILDREN

Suitable for age 5+ and free of charge. Children must be accompanied by an adult. Where booking is stated as required please call 01952 - 382340 or email: telfordtownpark@telford.gov.uk

Saturday 12 April, official opening of the new 12 hole adventure golf course. Also the water play area opens, FOTTP plant sale and funfair.

Tuesday 15 April, Family Pond dipping, Spout Pool, 11am - 3pm

Tuesday 22 April, RSPB Nature walks. Start times 11am, 1pm and 3pm. Meet at the Visitor Centre 10 minutes before.

Wednesday 23 April, A day of storytelling with local history themes to celebrate the opening of the new heritage trail. Booking required. Meet at the Visitor Centre.

Thursday 24 April, Family Fungi Walk, 10.30am - 12noon approx. Meet at the Visitor Centre 10 minutes before.

Please note activities may be subject to change. For further details about any of the above activities and future events visit: <http://www.telfordtownpark.co.uk> or telephone 01952 - 382340



Keep up to date with the Friends of Telford Town Park

Visit our website www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

Find us on Facebook <https://www.facebook.com/FOTTP>

Follow us on Twitter <https://twitter.com/FOTTP>

Call into the Park Visitor Centre or telephone 01952 - 382340

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